



INDONESIA

Capital city: Jakarta**Area:** 741,096 sq miles
(1,919,440 sq km)**Population:** 220,000,000**Official language:** Bahasa Indonesia**Major religions:** Muslim 87%, Christian 9%, other 4%**Government:** Multi-party democracy**Currency:** Rupiah**Adult literacy rate:** 88%**Life expectancy:** 67 years**People per doctor:** 6,564**Televisions:** 136 per 1,000 people

BRUNEI

Capital city: Bandar Seri Begawan**Area:** 2,228 sq miles
(5,770 sq km)**Population:** 358,000**Official language:** Malay**Major religions:** Muslim 66%, Buddhist 14%, Christian 10%, other 10%**Government:** Absolute monarchy**Currency:** Brunei dollar**Adult literacy rate:** 94%**Life expectancy:** 77 years**People per doctor:** 929**Televisions:** 241 per 1,000 people

EAST TIMOR

Capital city: Dili**Area:** 5,794 sq miles
(15,007 sq km)**Population:** 778,000**Official languages:** Tetum, Portuguese**Major religions:** Roman Catholic 95%, other 5%**Government:** Multi-party democracy**Currency:** US Dollar (transitional currency)**Adult literacy rate:** 59%**Life expectancy:** 65 years**People per doctor:** 40,000**Televisions:** 56 per 1,000 people

INDONESIA

EVERYTHING ABOUT INDONESIA IS BIG. It is the world's largest archipelago, made up of 18,108 islands, of which only about 1,500 are inhabited. It stretches for 3,169 miles (5,100 km) and is spread across 3 million sq miles (8 million sq km) of sea and three time zones. The population contains 362 different ethnic groups, speaking over 250 languages and dialects. More than 190 million Indonesians are Muslim, making it the world's biggest Muslim country. It is also a land of contrasts: along with its modern cities and industries, Indonesia contains peoples whose lifestyles have not altered for centuries.

THE SPICE ISLANDS

For centuries, the Moluccas islands in eastern Indonesia were Europe's main source of cloves, nutmeg, cinnamon, and other spices. While Indonesia was a Dutch colony, the merchants of the Dutch East India Company had total control of this trade and grew fabulously rich. Indonesia became an independent country in 1949.



The temple of Borobudur is the world's largest Buddhist monument.

BOROBUDUR

Situated in the heart of Java is one of the architectural wonders of the world. The vast Buddhist temple of Borobudur – which means “monastery on the hill” in Javanese – was built between AD 778–856. The temple consists of a series of platforms, each one representing a different stage in the Buddhist's spiritual journey from ignorance, through enlightenment, to nirvana, or heavenly bliss.



JAKARTA

Indonesia's capital is home to more than 17 million people, making it the largest city in Southeast Asia. It was originally a small trading port at the mouth of the Ciliwung River, shipping spices throughout eastern Asia. In 1618, the Dutch made Jayakarta, as it was then called, the capital of their East Indies Empire. They renamed the town Batavia and rebuilt it around canals to look like Amsterdam.



OIL AND GAS

The first oil well was drilled in Sumatra in 1871, and oil has dominated the Indonesian economy ever since. By 1981 oil and gas products made up more than 80 percent of exports, but this figure is now dropping as the oil reserves begin to run out. To reduce dependence on oil, Indonesia is exploiting its reserves of natural gas. The gas is exported in a liquid form, called liquefied natural gas.

BALI

With lush plants covering the island in a carpet of green and sandy beaches stretching along the coast, Bali is one of the world's most beautiful places. It is a favorite destination for tourists, who come to enjoy the scenery and to watch local groups of musicians perform ancient dances. Most Balinese are Hindu, and processions, like these women taking offerings to the temple, are part of everyday life.